

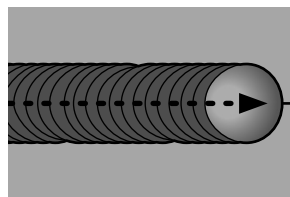
Basic Wire Welding Technique

1. Press (and hold) Trigger and contact the area to be welded with electrode wire to ignite arc.
2. For a narrow weld, you can usually draw the wire in a steady straight line. This is called a **stringer bead**.

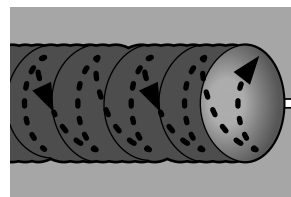
For a wider weld, draw the wire back and forth across the joint.

This is called a **weave bead** and takes practice to perform properly.

stringer bead

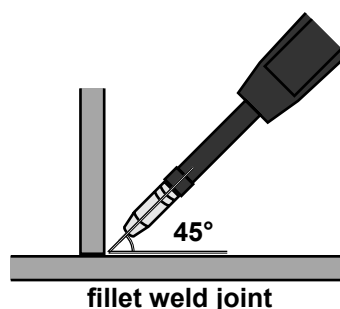


weave bead

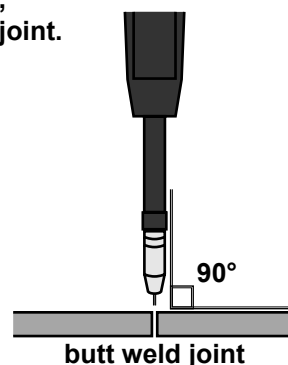


3. Direct the welding wire straight into the joint. This gives an angle of 90° (straight up and down) for butt (end to end) welds, and an angle of 45° for fillet (T-shaped) welds.

Weld MIG Gun angles, viewed from front of weld joint.



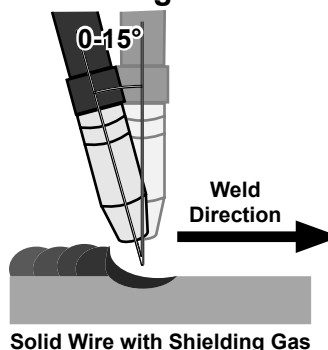
fillet weld joint



butt weld joint

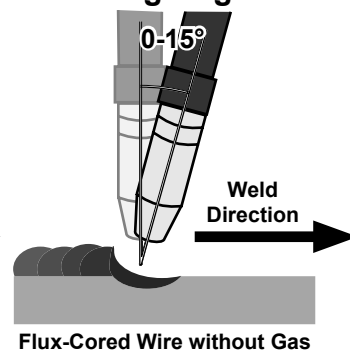
4. For MIG welding using solid wire and shielding gas, the end of the MIG Gun should be tilted so that wire is angled anywhere in-between straight on and 15° away from the direction you are welding. The amount of tilt is called the **push angle**.

Push Angle



Solid Wire with Shielding Gas

Drag Angle



Flux-Cored Wire without Gas

5. When using flux-cored wire without shielding gas, the end of the MIG Gun should be tilted so that wire is angled anywhere in-between straight on and 15° in the direction you are welding. The amount of tilt is called the **drag angle**.

6. The Contact Tip should remain within 1/2" of the work surface. This distance is called **CTWD** - Contact Tip to Work Distance.

